# WORD FORMATION
# Lessons 1 + 2

**Find the job → choose the family → check meaning → check spelling.**

## 1 · NOUNS - name a person, thing, or idea

Clue: a clear **decision**; two **decisions**. Find the head of the noun phrase, then check singular/plural.

| Affix / pattern | Meaning / job | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| -tion / -sion | action or result | communicate → communication; decide → decision |
| -ment | action or result | develop → development; improve → improvement |
| -ance / -ence | action, quality, or state | perform → performance; exist → existence |
| -er / -or | person doing an action | teach → teacher; act → actor |
| -ity | quality or state | possible → possibility; active → activity |
| -ness | quality or state | kind → kindness; happy → happiness |
| -ship | relationship, position, or skill | friend → friendship; leader → leadership |
| -hood | life stage or state | child → childhood; neighbour → neighbourhood |
| -dom | state or condition | free → freedom; wise → wisdom |
| -ism / -ist | system/activity; person | tour → tourism; art → artist |

## 2 · ADJECTIVES - describe a noun or subject

Clue: a **useful** tool; the tool seems **useful**. Decide whether the meaning is positive or negative.

| Affix / pattern | Meaning / job | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| -ful / -less | having / without | careful / careless; useful / useless |
| -able / -ible | can be done; suitable | rely → reliable; access → accessible |
| -ive | having a quality | create → creative; effect → effective |
| -ous | having a quality | danger → dangerous; fame → famous |
| -al / -ic | connected with | culture → cultural; energy → energetic |

**Quick checks:** happy → happiness (y changes to i); possible → possibility; decide → decision, not “decidement”. Friendship is the relationship; friendliness is the quality.

## 3 · VERBS - express an action or state

Clue: to / can / should + base verb: We need to **simplify**. Check the tense if the sentence needs one.

| Affix / pattern | Meaning / job | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| -ise / -ize | make or become | modern → modernise/modernize; priority → prioritise/prioritize |
| -ify | make or cause to become | simple → simplify; clear → clarify |
| -en | make or become more | wide → widen; broad → broaden |
| -ate | make, cause, or perform | active → activate; valid → validate |

## 4 · ADVERBS - describe how, or modify another word

Clue: She explains **clearly**. But: a surprisingly **clear** explanation - the gap there is an adjective.

| Affix / pattern | Meaning / job | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| -ly | usual manner ending | quick → quickly; careful → carefully |
| -y → -ily | spelling change | happy → happily; easy → easily |
| -ic → -ically | usual spelling from -ic | basic → basically; automatic → automatically |
| irregular / unchanged | learn the whole form | good → well; fast → fast; hard → hard |

## 5 · PREFIXES - change the meaning

Most keep the word class: interpret → misinterpret is still a verb. Choose an established word, not any prefix that looks possible.

| Affix / pattern | Meaning / job | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| un- / dis- | not, opposite, or reverse | unhappy; unreliable; dishonest; disagree |
| in- / im- / il- / ir- | not; fixed word families | incorrect; impossible; illegal; irregular |
| re- | again or back | rewrite; reconsider; rebuild |
| mis- | wrongly or badly | misinterpret; misunderstand; misjudge |
| over- / under- | too much / too little | overthink; overestimate / underestimate; underpay |
| pre- / post- | before / after | prepay; preview / postwar; postgraduate |
| inter- | between | international; interact; interconnected |
| co- | together | cooperate; co-worker; co-author |

**Spelling:** simple → simplify; clear → clarify; wide → widen. Careful → carefully has two l's. Modernise and modernize are both accepted spellings.

**Watch out:** friendly is an adjective. Hard = with effort; hardly = almost not. Prefixes are word-specific: do not replace un-, in-, and dis- freely.